DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 3

Web designer

Profession 3 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A web designer plans the look, layout and content of a website so visitors can find information and act. Web design overlaps with web development: the designer decides how the site should look and work; the developer builds it.

What professionals do every day

Plans sitemaps and user journeys, designs page layouts, creates a style system, prepares responsive designs, tests with users and hands over specifications.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

A website is often a business's first impression and main sales tool. A designer makes it clear, fast and easy to use on any device.

- Sites that look good on a laptop and break on a phone.
- Confusing navigation and unclear calls to action.
- Low contrast and small text that exclude readers.

Skills you need

- Information architecture and sitemaps.
- Layout, grids and responsive design.
- Accessible colour and type.
- Prototyping and user testing.
- Basic HTML and CSS to understand what is possible.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Figma	Layout design and prototypes	Free starter	Paid plans	www.figma.com
Webflow	Design and build websites	Free plan	Paid plans	webflow.com
Framer	Design and publish sites	Free tier	Paid plans	www.framer.com
Maze	User testing	Free tier	Paid plans	maze.co

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Redesign one page of a real or fictional site.
Intermediate	Design a responsive homepage with a sitemap.
Advanced	Run a five-person usability test and fix the top three problems.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Four-page brochure site for a clinic.
- **Intermediate:** Booking flow for a salon.
- **Advanced:** Product catalogue redesign.

Client-ready portfolio project

A complete website design for a fictional local business: sitemap, desktop and phone layouts for three pages, a style guide with contrast checks, and a usability test summary.

Worked example

Worked example. A homepage with one clear action: the 'Book now' button is the only filled, high-contrast element above the fold, and the phone layout places it at the thumb-reach area.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Sitemap and phone layout test

Business problem: A clinic needs a homepage that gets bookings from phones.

Steps

1. Draw a sitemap with five pages.
2. Design the homepage at 390 px and 1280 px.
3. Check that the primary button passes contrast AA.
4. Run a three-person task test: book a visit.

Expected output: Sitemap, two layouts and a test note.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

The sitemap shows five pages. The phone layout puts the one primary action within thumb reach. The button colour pair is checked with the contrast tool before the design is handed over.

Common mistakes

- Designing for the desktop only.
- Skipping the sitemap, so pages duplicate each other.
- Light grey text that fails contrast.
- No user testing before handover.

Freelancing opportunities

- Website design for small businesses.
- Redesign projects for existing sites.
- Briefs for 'website design', 'UI web design', 'landing page design'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Nielsen Norman Group articles
- WCAG 2.2 quick reference

Part of **Master Freelancing: Design and Creative**. **Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in** · **Open the full textbook**. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.